

1980 DOUBLE ELECTION CAMPAIGN PLEDGES

LIBERAL DEMOCRATIC PARTY (LDP)
OHIRA, PRESIDENT

51:80

1. Inflation

Our highest priority is to stabilize prices. In order to restrain the inflation rate of consumer prices this year to about 6.4 percent, we will do the following: 1) tighten the money supply and hold down the overall supply by, among other things, adjusting the speed at which public projects are executed; 2) strengthen the investigation and supervision over individual goods whose prices have increased markedly; 3) strictly enforce the Anti-Monopoly Law in order to prevent industry collusion to raise prices; 4) preventing price gouging; 5) strengthen measures to stabilize the prices of fresh food; and 6) strengthen regulations on investment real estate dealings.

2. Welfare

In order to secure a stable and worthwhile life for the aged in a mature society and to further the welfare of the handicapped and of mothers and children, we will do the following: 1) revise the imbalances and irrationalities in the complicated social security system, raise the benefits of pensions, fulfill guarantees for medical care, and improve social welfare; and 2)

set up a materially and morally rich Japanese-style welfare society that brings together comprehensive social security, freedom for families, and environmentally rich communities.

3. Education

Our goal for education is to provide rich individuality and creativity, a feeling of social solidarity and public spirit, and a national and international consciousness in the development of our youth. 1) We will revise education, which is based on cramming and an overemphasis on intellectual training, through a new curriculum that is less rigid and at the same time harmonizes knowledge, intellectual training, and physical training. 2) We will realize thorough education by promoting the attainment of 40 student classrooms. 3) We will strive to abolish examination hell and push for the improvement of the university entrance examination system.

4. Energy

To overcome the oil crisis and stabilize a long term supply of energy, we will strive to reduce our dependence on oil from 75 percent to 50 percent by the year 1990. We will do the following: 1) promote the development and introduction of coal, nuclear power, thermal and solar energy, and other alternate energy sources; 2) promote, in particular, the building of nuclear electric power plants while guaranteeing safety; 3) secure the stable supply of oil by dispersing our sources of oil; and 4) push for an all-out effort to conserve energy and oil.

5. Security and Defense

As extra insurance in guaranteeing security in order to deal with the world situation stirred up by the increase in the military power of the Soviet Union around Japan, we will do the following: 1) actively promote peace diplomacy; 2) maintain defense strength in accordance with our country's natural resources and situation; 3) maintain the Japan-U.S. security system and advance defense cooperation; and 4) strive to set up a national defense council for the establishment of a defense system, maintain a residential defense system, enact spy prevention legislation, and set up a secure system to deal with emergencies.

6. Political Ethics

In order to secure discipline and establish impartial politics at every point in the government, we will strive to do the following: 1) strengthen penalties and lengthen the statute of limitations regarding corruption; 2) enforce discipline and enact an ethics charter that will set standards for the behavior of political parties and politicians; 3) disclose how individual political funds are managed; 4) reform the election system so that it does not cost money; 5) strengthen administrative inspection and carry out sure penalty and rewards for public officials; and 6) rationalize public accounting.

7. Administrative Reform

In order to realize a simple, efficient, and vigorous

administration, we will strive to do the following: 1) unify and consolidate the local, affiliated and "block" agencies of the national government; 2) consolidate the 18 semigovernment corporations and simplify and rationalize other specially chartered and licensed corporations; 3) introduce a system of retirement for public officials and reduce the number of national public officials by 37 thousand; 4) restrain excessive administrative intervention in the private sector; 5) radically reorganize the articles of licensing and authorizations; and 6) carry out the smooth disclosure of information.

JAPAN SOCIALIST PARTY (JSP) 52:80
ASUKATA, CHAIRMAN

1. Inflation

We will restrict unjustified price increases by invoking the relevant laws (生活二法) to prevent the cornering of markets and the hoarding of goods, by strengthening safeguards against price gouging, and by institutionalizing the public disclosure of the costs. We will freeze increases in the present public utility charges and eliminate anticipatory rate increases. We will devise a plan for the production and shipping of vegetables and thereby realize a stable supply. We will reform the distribution machinery and fulfill consumer administration. We will restrain inflation by strengthening the enforcement of the Anti-Monopoly Law and democratizing the Bank of Japan's policy committee.